

Close the Gap with Referrals.

The Asymmetric Bet.

Don't drop the price unilaterally. Take referrals as the counterweight. The buyer gets what they wanted. You get the network.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 Vision board ↔ deal form**
Same shape. Same discipline. Personal goals = deal mechanics.
- 02 The 6-field sequence**
Said in order. Every time. Product first, price second.
- 03 The cooler question**
Layer a softer question over your real ask.
- 04 Referrals as counterweight**
7 referrals ≈ 70 saved cold calls. The maths is wild.
- 05 Contingency, not discount**
The word matters. Reframes the give as a trade.
- 06 Handover with momentum**
Don't walk away — set up months 1, 2, 3.
- 07 Daily reference card**
Print and pin.

Vision board ↔ deal form.

The way you treat your own goals is the way you treat your deals. Same shape. Same discipline.

YOUR GOAL

- 1. When? — 12 months from now
- 2. What? — Deposit on a house
- 3. Where do I need to be? — \$80k saved
- 4. Where am I? — \$30k saved
- 5. What's holding me back? — Not tracking weekly
- 6. Conditions to close gap? — Auto-transfer \$250/wk

YOUR DEAL

- 1. When? — Closing today, 3pm
- 2. What? — SEO Support @ \$625/m + \$250 setup
- 3. Where does client need to be? — \$500/month
- 4. What did I end up offering? — SEO Support only
- 5. What's holding her back? — The setup fee
- 6. Closing conditions? — Setup waived, must commit Mon

THE PARALLEL

Reps who can run six fields on their own goals can run six fields on a deal. Reps who can't do either need to start with the goal — the deal follows.

The cooler question.

Layer a softer question on top of your real ask. The buyer responds to the cooler — and the real ask follows the warm answer.

01 · THE REAL ASK

"Can I have your business?" or "Would you give me a few referrals?" or "Can we close this today?"



02 · THE COOLER (LAID ON TOP)

"By the way — you've been in business 22 years. You must know a lot of people."

WHY IT WORKS

01 The cooler warms the buyer up

They respond to the second question first — "yeah, I know lots of people" — which puts them in a giving frame of mind.

02 The real ask gets the warm answer

Whatever they say to the cooler, they say to the real ask. Yes follows yes.

03 It defuses the ego defence

A direct ask triggers defence. A layered ask triggers reflection. The cooler is the reflection layer.

Referrals as the counterweight.

Don't drop the price unilaterally. Trade it for referrals. The maths is wildly in your favour.

7

REFERRALS

Buyer gives you 7 names of people they know.

≈

70

COLD CALLS

Rough conversion — 1 in 10 cold calls produces a warm contact.

THE PITCH SEQUENCE

01 Identify the gap

"Sounds like the price is the last blocker."

02 Cool it

"By the way — you must know a lot of people after 22 years in this game."

03 Ask for the names

"Three or four names — don't need business details, just people I could potentially talk to."

04 Take it to the director

Use the word contingency — never discount.

05 Come back with the deal

"Director approved — contingent on those referrals."

Contingency, not discount.

The word matters. "Contingency" frames it as a trade. "Discount" frames it as a giveaway.

DISCOUNT · THE WRONG WORD

"The director approved a discount."

WHAT BUYER HEARS:

- The original price was inflated.
- I could have pushed harder.
- The rep folds under pressure.
- Everything else they said was likely inflated too.
- I'll push for more next time.

CONTINGENCY · THE RIGHT WORD

"Director approved — contingent on the referrals."

WHAT BUYER HEARS:

- I earned this — it wasn't a giveaway.
- There are conditions — this is a real trade.
- The value of the work hasn't moved.
- I'm now invested in delivering my side.
- I'm now part of the relationship.

THE WORD CHOICE

Practise saying "contingency" out loud. It feels unnatural at first. After you've used it five times, it lands naturally — and the buyer's posture shifts every time.

Handover with momentum.

Don't walk away after the close. Set up months 1, 2, and 3 — by name, by date, by accountability.

INTRODUCE THE ACCOUNT MANAGER

01

"I'm going to personally hand you over to Taylor. Here's her name. Here's how to reach her."

BOOK THE MONTH-1 CHECK-IN

02

"I'll touch base with you at month one. Just to see how the campaign's running."

BOOK THE MONTH-2 CHECK-IN

03

"Same again at month two. By then we should be seeing the first real movement."

SECURE THE REFERRAL HANDSHAKE

04

"At month three — if we're delivering — I'll come back to you about those referrals. Sound fair?"

WHAT THIS DOES

Reassures the buyer (post-sale momentum). Secures the referral pipeline (you need to be in contact to collect). Makes the next deal easier (you're now a partner).

Daily reference card.

Print and pin. Read before every closing call.

DO · EVERY DEAL

- Fill the 6-field form before you come to the director.
- Product first. Price second. Setup fee third.
- Cool every big ask with a softer question first.
- Trade referrals for any price contingency.
- Use the word "contingency" — never "discount."
- Set up month 1, 2, 3 check-ins by name.
- Get the referral handshake at month 3.
- Treat selling as a craft — not a transaction.

DON'T · EVER

- Don't say price before product name.
- Don't drop the price unilaterally.
- Don't say "discount" — say "contingency."
- Don't accept "I'll think about it" at face value.
- Don't walk away after the close.
- Don't ask for referrals without the cooler.
- Don't improvise the sequence — say it in order.
- Don't go to the director without filling field 6.

WATCH-OUTS

- Reps who skip the goal-on-wall exercise.
- Pitch that swaps price and product.
- Cooler questions that sound rehearsed.
- Referral asks with no follow-through.
- Director conversations that lead with the price.
- Handovers that lose momentum at month 2.
- Closes that don't book month 3 explicitly.
- Treating tactics as strategy.

THE ONE-LINER

Cool the ask. Take referrals as the counterweight. Call it a contingency. Hand over with momentum.